NASSAU CANDY

DISTRIBUTOR ANALYTICS

Executive Summary

Product profitability and margin performance

Decision-maker briefing | Prepared 21 October 2026

Prepared from the supplied Nassau Candy Distributor CSV and project brief.

Purpose and approach

This analysis tests whether Nassau Candy Distributor's recorded sales translate into gross profit and identifies where management should focus product pricing, cost management, and portfolio reviews. It uses 10,194 usable rows from the supplied dataset, 15 products, and three product divisions. Data checks found no missing values, exact duplicate rows, or material mismatch in Gross Profit = Sales - Cost. All records remain usable for financial analysis. The major data caveat is that every Ship Date is 904-1,642 days after Order Date; shipment-performance conclusions are not reliable until those dates are verified.

Headline indicators

Indicator	Result
Total sales	$141,783.63
Total gross profit	$93,442.80
Total cost	$48,340.83
Weighted gross margin	65.91%
Cost as share of sales	34.09%
Units recorded	38,654
Distinct products / customers	15 / 5,044
Monthly margin volatility	0.525 percentage points (SD)

What the analysis says

- **Chocolate is the earnings engine.** It generates $131,692.90 in sales, $88,824.62 gross profit, 92.88% of revenue, and 95.06% of gross profit. Its weighted gross margin is 67.45%.
- **Profit is concentrated in five products.** The top five account for 92.88% of revenue and 95.06% of positive gross profit. Protecting availability and margin on these products is a priority.
- **Kazookles is the clearest margin-review candidate.** It has $1,205.75 sales, $92.75 gross profit, 7.69% gross margin, and 92.31% cost ratio. Review realized prices, discounts, cost components, and the product's strategic role before making any assortment decision.
- **Other underperforms its revenue share.** Its 44.84% weighted margin produces 4.64% of profit from 6.82% of revenue. A product mix and cost review is warranted.
- **High percentages on tiny products are weak evidence.** Everlasting Gobstopper has 80.00% margin but only $130.00 sales and 3 source rows. Validate demand before scaling it.
- **Geographic exposure is measurable.** Pacific is the largest region at $46,301.53 revenue (32.66%); California is the largest state at $27,917.40 (19.69%). This is customer concentration, not proof of delivery congestion.

Division comparison

Division	Sales	Gross Profit	Gross Margin (%)	Revenue Contribution (%)	Profit Contribution (%)	Rows	Products
Chocolate	$131,692.90	$88,824.62	67.45%	92.88%	95.06%	9844	5
Other	$9,663.25	$4,333.45	44.84%	6.82%	4.64%	310	3
Sugar	$427.48	$284.73	66.61%	0.30%	0.30%	40	7

Prioritized recommendations

1. Immediately verify the upstream Ship Date field and clarify what those dates mean. Do not use order-to-ship elapsed time as a logistics performance score until corrected.
2. Run a focused product review for Kazookles: validate cost calculation, supplier/manufacturing cost, discounts, and net realized price; only then decide on repricing or further action.
3. Review pricing, cost structure, and discount history for Lickable Wallpaper and Wonka Gum; use contribution profit and demand information, not margin alone.
4. Protect the top five Chocolate products with regular availability and margin monitoring; assess portfolio diversification as a resilience measure rather than assuming low-selling products will scale.
5. Investigate Other division's product mix and high cost burden; establish a monthly weighted-margin and contribution dashboard by product.
6. Validate the supplied product-factory mapping. Product name coverage is 15/15, but Fizzy Lifting Drinks has a division-label mismatch between the brief and the dataset.

Data limitations and interpretation guardrails

- All products show positive aggregate gross profit in this dataset; no product should be called loss-making from the provided financial records.
- Gross margin is gross profit divided by sales, not full net profitability. Selling, distribution, overhead, discount, return, and demand-elasticity details are not supplied.
- The supplied Order ID appears product-coded, so sales divided by distinct Order IDs is not treated as definitive basket-level average order value.
- Factory summaries associate products with the brief's named factories; they do not measure factory operating efficiency, capacity, or actual shipment routes.
- The project brief's final sentence about shipping route efficiency conflicts with the central product-profitability scope; this deliverable focuses on product economics.

Bottom line

The business generates a 65.91% weighted gross margin, but results are highly concentrated in five Chocolate products. The clearest near-term analytical action is to validate and investigate Kazookles' 7.69% margin and review the Other division's cost burden, while correcting shipment dates before expanding into logistics KPIs. Repricing and discontinuation decisions should wait for validated price, cost-component, and demand evidence.